Resume Writing for Freshers

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Introduction

A resume (also called a CV, curriculum vitae) is a short document that summarises your education, skills, projects and experience to show an employer why you are a good fit for a job or internship. For a fresher, a student or recent graduate with little or no work experience, the resume is often the first and only chance to make an impression. Recruiters typically spend only about 6 to 10 seconds on a first look at a resume, so it must be clear, honest, well organised and relevant. A resume is different from a biodata, which includes personal details such as father's name and religion; modern resumes leave out these details. A good resume gets you shortlisted for an interview, but it does not need to tell your whole life story.

What Sections Should a Fresher's Resume Have?

A fresher's resume should have the following sections. First, the header with contact details: your full name, phone number, a professional email address (such as firstname.lastname@gmail.com, not a nickname), city, and links to your LinkedIn profile and, for technical roles, GitHub or portfolio. A photograph, date of birth, religion, marital status and full postal address are not needed. Second, a career objective or professional summary of two to three lines that states your goal and key strengths, tailored to the job, such as "Final-year B.E. student with skills in Python and machine learning seeking a data analyst internship". Third, education, listed with the most recent first, with degree, college, university, year of passing and CGPA or percentage, along with class 12 and class 10 results. For freshers, education usually comes before experience. Fourth, skills, divided into technical skills (programming languages, tools, software) and soft skills such as communication and teamwork, being honest about your level. Fifth, projects, which are very important for freshers: give the project name, a one-line description, the technologies used and the result or your contribution, for example "Built a face-mask detection system using OpenCV and Python with 94 percent accuracy". Sixth, internships and work experience, if any, including part-time jobs and volunteering. Seventh, certifications and courses, such as those from NPTEL, Coursera or company certifications. Eighth, achievements and awards, such as hackathons, competitions, scholarships and ranks. Ninth, extracurricular activities and leadership roles, such as club roles, sports and NSS or NCC. Optional sections include languages known, publications and hobbies. A "declaration" statement at the end is not necessary.

What Is an ATS?

ATS stands for Applicant Tracking System. It is software used by companies and recruiters to collect, store, scan, sort and rank job applications automatically. When many candidates apply, the ATS parses (reads) each resume, extracts information such as name, education, skills and experience, and matches it against the keywords and requirements of the job description, then gives a ranking or filters out resumes that do not match, so recruiters see the top-matching ones first. Large companies, and most big employers, use ATS tools such as Workday, Taleo, Greenhouse and Lever. Because the software cannot read some formats well, a beautifully designed resume may be misread. Tips for an ATS-friendly resume: use a simple, clean, single-column layout; use standard headings such as Education, Skills, Projects and Experience; avoid tables, text boxes, images, icons, graphs, headers and footers; use standard fonts such as Arial, Calibri or Times New Roman at 10 to 12 points; include keywords from the job description, such as the exact skill names; spell out abbreviations at least once; use standard bullet points; and save the file in the format requested, usually PDF or DOCX, with a clear file name such as "Name_Role.pdf".

How Long Should a Resume Be?

A fresher's resume should be one page long. Recruiters prefer concise resumes, and a fresher does not have enough experience to need more. Experienced professionals with more than ten years of experience may use two pages, and academic CVs for research may be longer. Use margins of about 0.5 to 1 inch, consistent formatting, and enough white space. Keep the content relevant: focus on what the employer needs and remove outdated or irrelevant items.

How to Write Strong Bullet Points

Begin each bullet with a strong action verb, such as developed, designed, built, led, analysed, implemented, organised or improved. Quantify results wherever possible with numbers: "Organised a technical symposium with 500 participants" is better than "Helped in organising a symposium". Use the past tense for completed work and keep each bullet to one or two lines. A simple formula is: Action plus Task plus Result. Avoid vague claims like "hard-working" without proof, and avoid first-person pronouns such as "I".

Tailoring and Common Mistakes

Tailor your resume to each job by reading the job description and matching your skills, using the same keywords. Common mistakes include spelling and grammar errors, an unprofessional email address, a long paragraph instead of bullets, lies or exaggeration, which are often discovered in interviews and background checks, too many colours or fancy designs, missing contact information, listing every school activity, using a photograph in places where it is not required and sending the same resume to every company. Proofread carefully, and have a friend or a mentor review it. Ensure that your LinkedIn profile and GitHub match your resume.

Related Documents and Resources

A cover letter, a short one-page letter introducing yourself and explaining why you are applying, is useful in some cases. Platforms for freshers in India include LinkedIn, Naukri, Internshala, Indeed and company career pages, and college placement cells run campus drives. Many free resume templates are available, such as in Canva, Google Docs and Overleaf, but choose simple ones. Chennai has many IT companies such as HCL, TCS, Zoho and Cognizant that recruit freshers at colleges.

Challenges and Future

Fresh graduates often feel they have nothing to put in the resume. Projects, open-source contributions, internships, online courses and volunteering can fill this gap. In the future, video resumes, AI-based screening and skill-based hiring will become more common, but a clear, honest one-page resume will still be important.

Quick Facts

- A fresher's resume should include contact details, objective or summary, education, skills, projects, internships, certifications and achievements.
- ATS stands for Applicant Tracking System, software that scans and ranks resumes using keywords.
- A fresher's resume should be one page long.
- Avoid tables, images and fancy graphics to remain ATS-friendly.
- Begin bullet points with action verbs and include numbers for results.